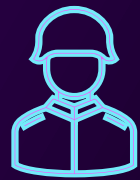


# ADVANCED TACTICAL CONVOY SOLUTIONS



UNCREWED GROUND VEHICLE (UGV)  
APPLICATIONS IN MODERN WARFARE



# AGENDA

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- Executive Summary
- UGV Mockup
- Mission Summary & GSA Tender Review
- Stated Requirements
- Recommended Additional Requirements
- System-Level Summary
- Design Concept Review
- UGV Selection Process and Justification
- Summary



# EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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- Installs in less than 5 hours
- Overall additional mass < 250kg
- GNSS-Denied tracking  $\pm 2\text{m}$
- 12-hour runtime
- <\$120k cost per unit



# EXECUTIVE SUMMARY CONT.

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- Supports multi-UGV convoys
- Validated in GNSS-denied scenarios (SIL/HIL)
- Redundant communications paths
- Field power-tested
- Ready for fleet staging





# HMMWV M998 UGV

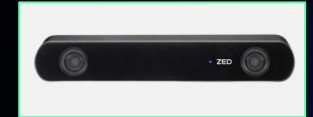
MOCKUP



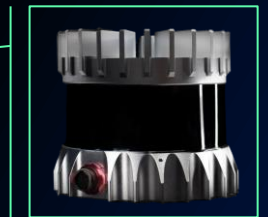


• Antenna Equipment

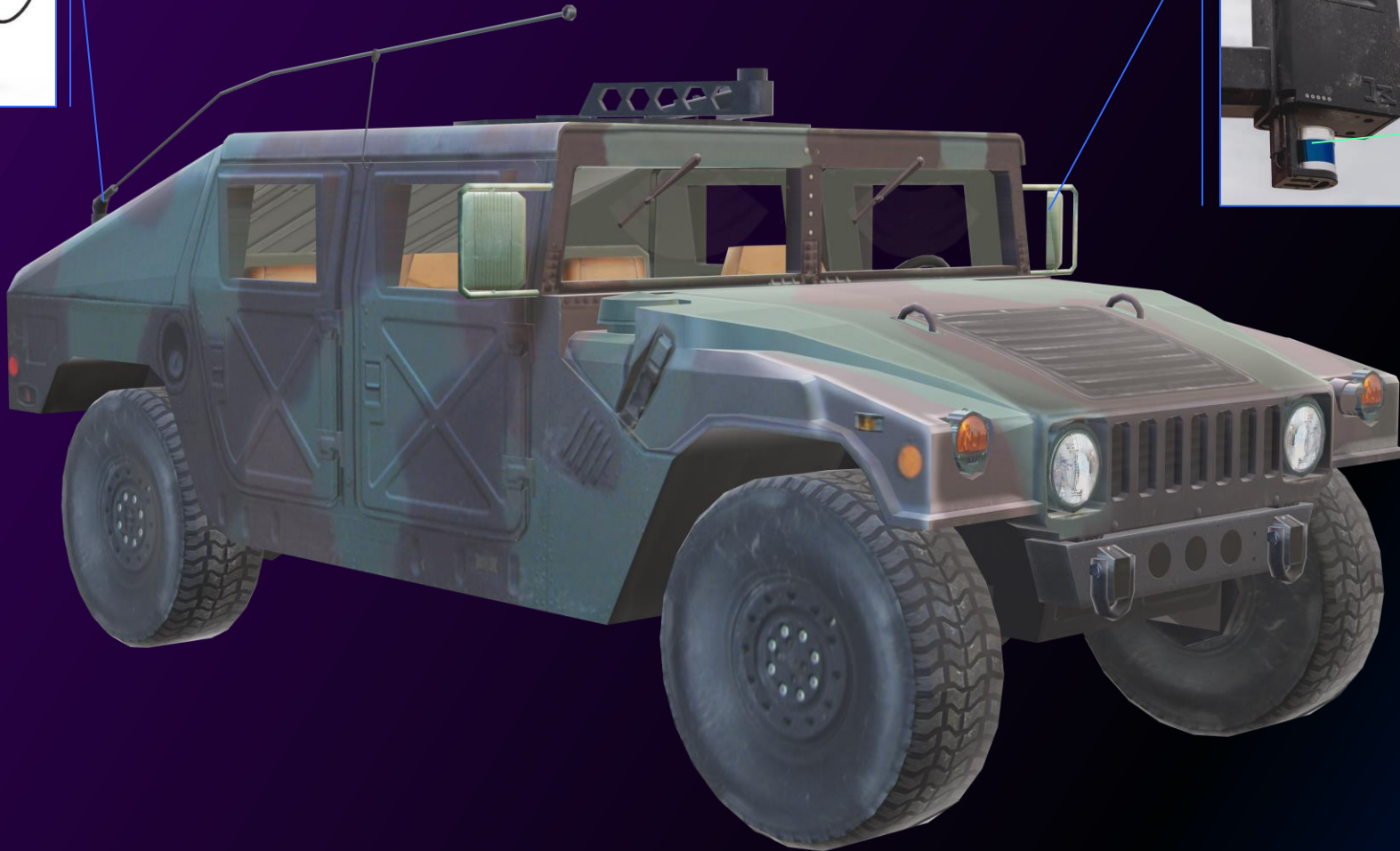
• Sensor Pod



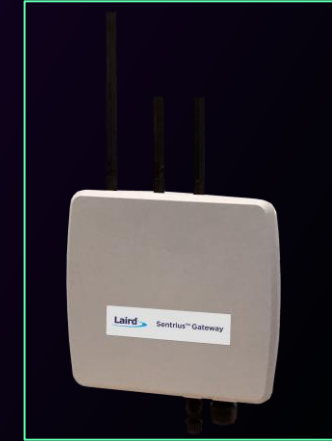
• Stereo Camera



• LIDAR Sensor







- Communications Equipment

- Computer Equipment





- Remote Operation - Vision

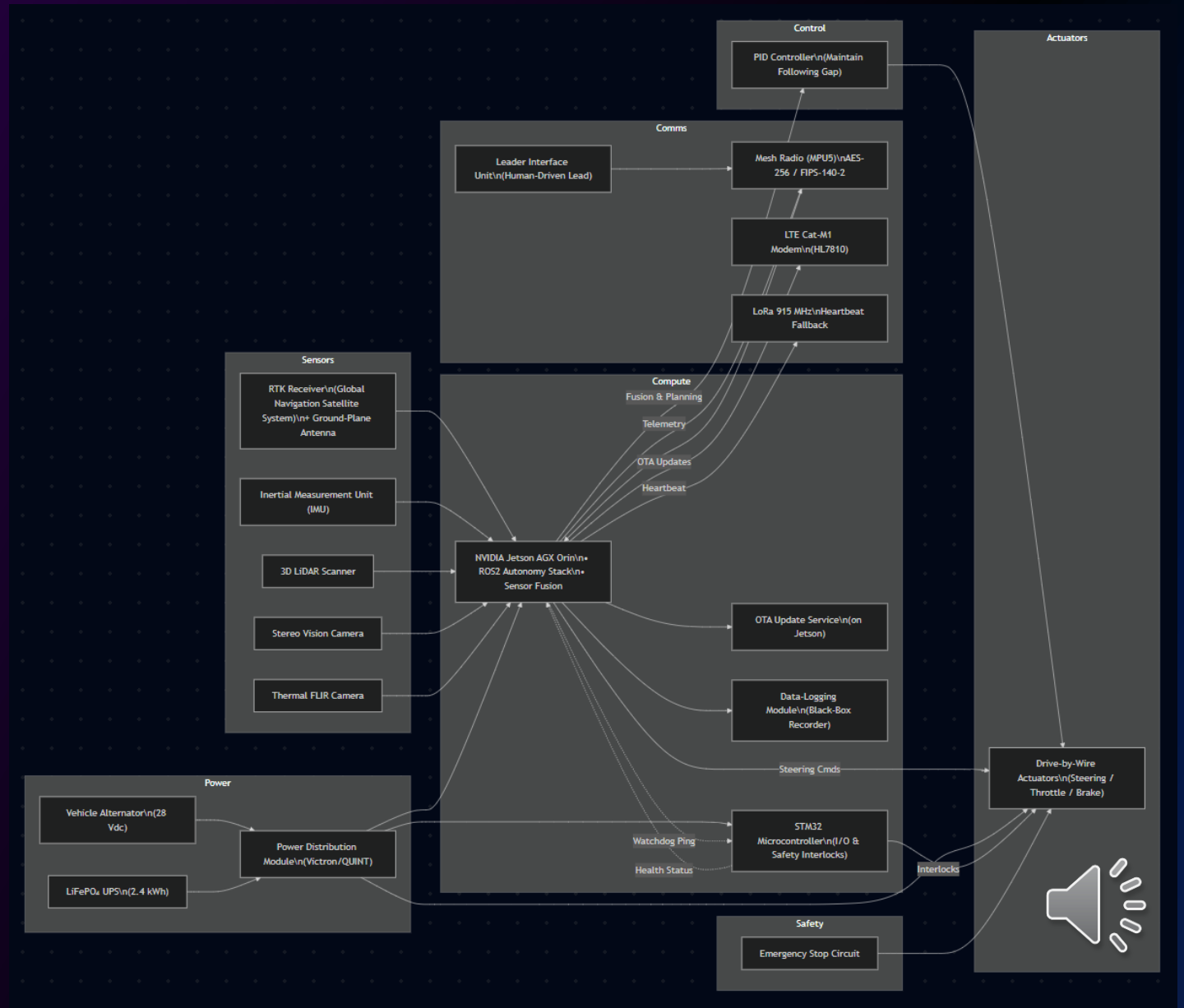
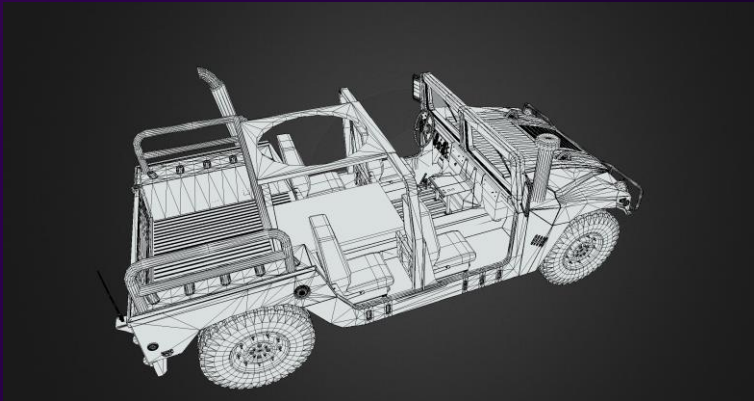


- Remote Operation - Control





# SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE



# MISSION SCENARIO

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- Follow lead HMMWV through off-road terrain
- Minimize performance degradation (speed, endurance, terrain compatibility).
- Support  $\geq 500$  lbs. payload.
- Maximize autonomy; allow occasional human input.
- Consider future expansion to multiple UGVs per leader vehicle.



# TENDER SPECIFICATIONS

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## Minimum Requirements

- Follow HMMWV off-road with minimal impact.
- Carry 500 lb payload.
- Operate with no continuous supervision.
- Avoid significant modification to lead vehicle.

## Recommendations

- Allow remote/local override of autonomous functions.
- Navigate in GNSS-denied environments.
- Enable OTA updates.
- Build scalability into initial offering.



# SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS



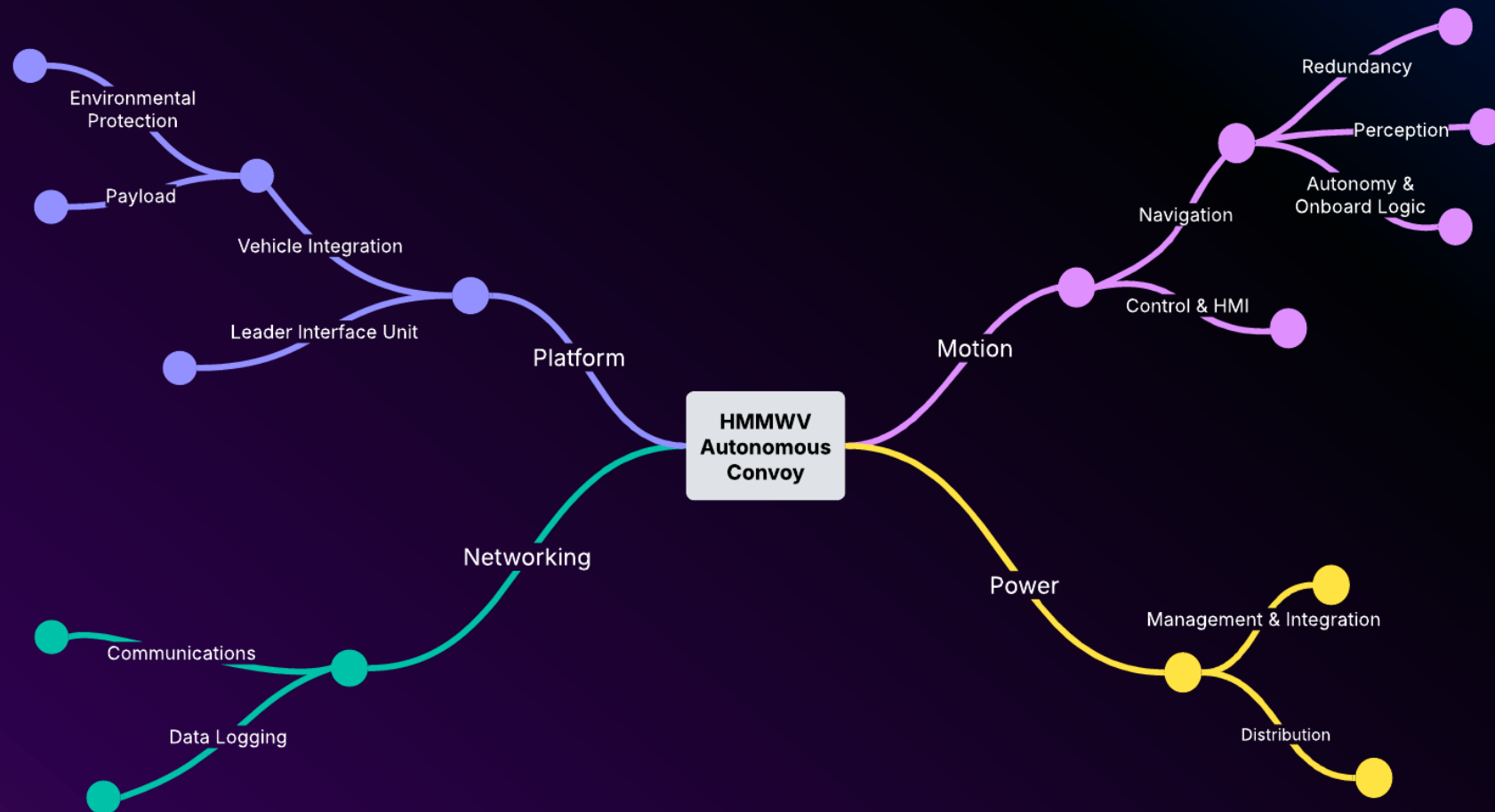
# REQUIREMENTS DEFINITIONS SAMPLE

| Function       | Requirement                    | Difficulty | Risk   | Subsystem       |
|----------------|--------------------------------|------------|--------|-----------------|
| Navigation     | Autonomous Leader-Follower     | High       | High   | Nav Stack       |
| Logistics      | Mission-Ready Cargo Capability | Medium     | Medium | Chassis/Payload |
| Autonomy       | Near-Zero Action               | Med        | High   | Autonomy Stack  |
| Communications | SAT/BT/WiFi/OTA                | Med        | Med    | Telemetry Stack |
| Control        | Intervention Capable           | Low        | Low    | UI Stack        |

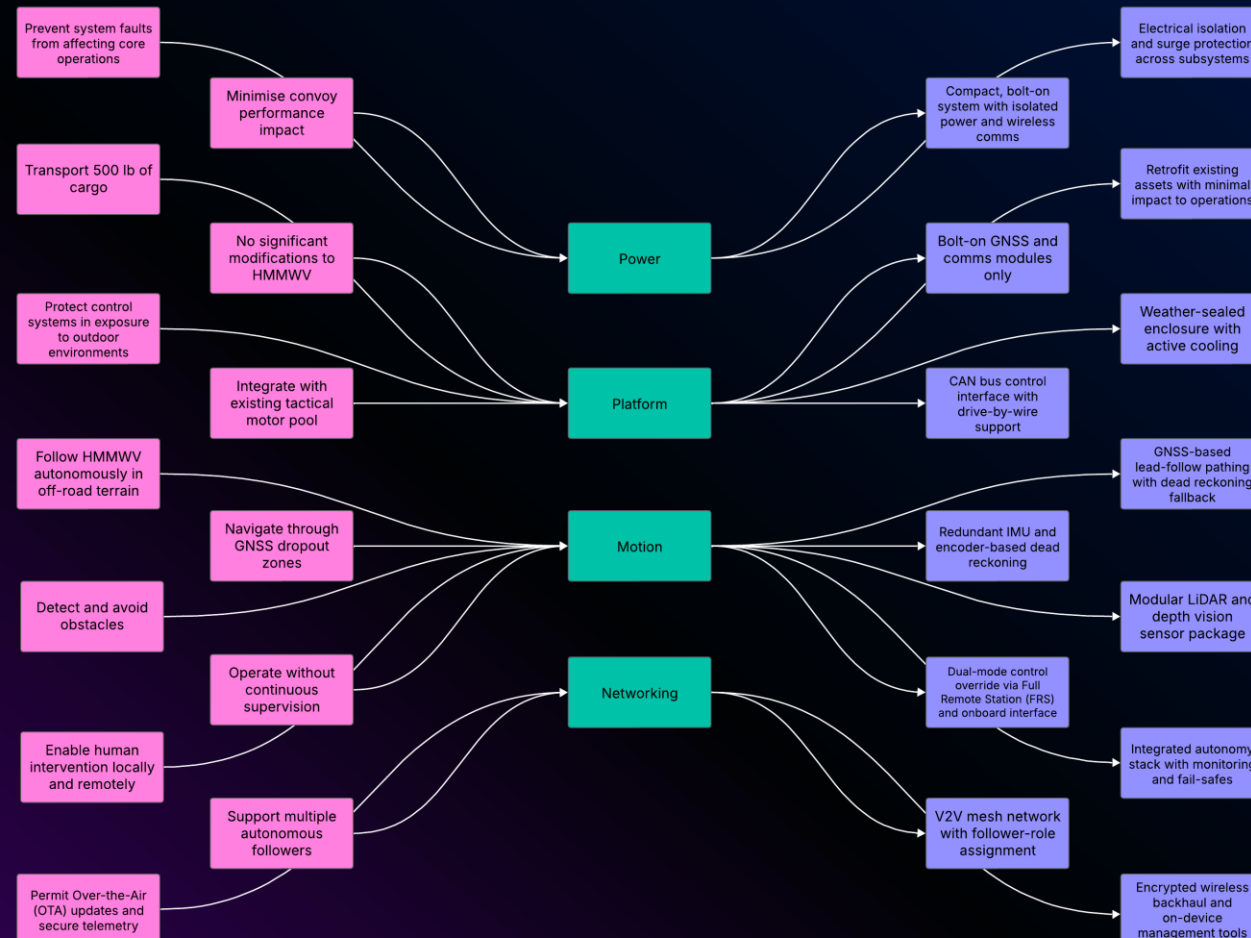




# SUBSYSTEM AMALGAMATION



# TRACEABILITY MATRIX



# TRADE STUDIES AND ANALYSIS - PERFORMED

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- External trade studies performed in relevant sectors of the industry that provide analytical justification for methodologies, as well as valuable lessons learned for future architecture implementations:
- Verification of heterogeneous multi-agent system using MCMAS
- Usability of Perception Sensors to Determine the Obstacles of Unmanned Ground Vehicles Operating in Off-Road Environments



# DESIGN PROCESS

## OVERVIEW



# DESIGN STRATEGY AND DEVELOPMENT



# ASSUMPTIONS

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1. Lead HMMWV remains unmodified (minor bolt-on only)
2. COTS and ITAR-compliant hardware
3. Terrain: NATO Class I–III
4. AO: Open terrain, semi-urban, no dense city-navigation
5. No invasive wiring or structural modifications
6. Temperature band: -20°C to +55°C





# CONSTRAINTS

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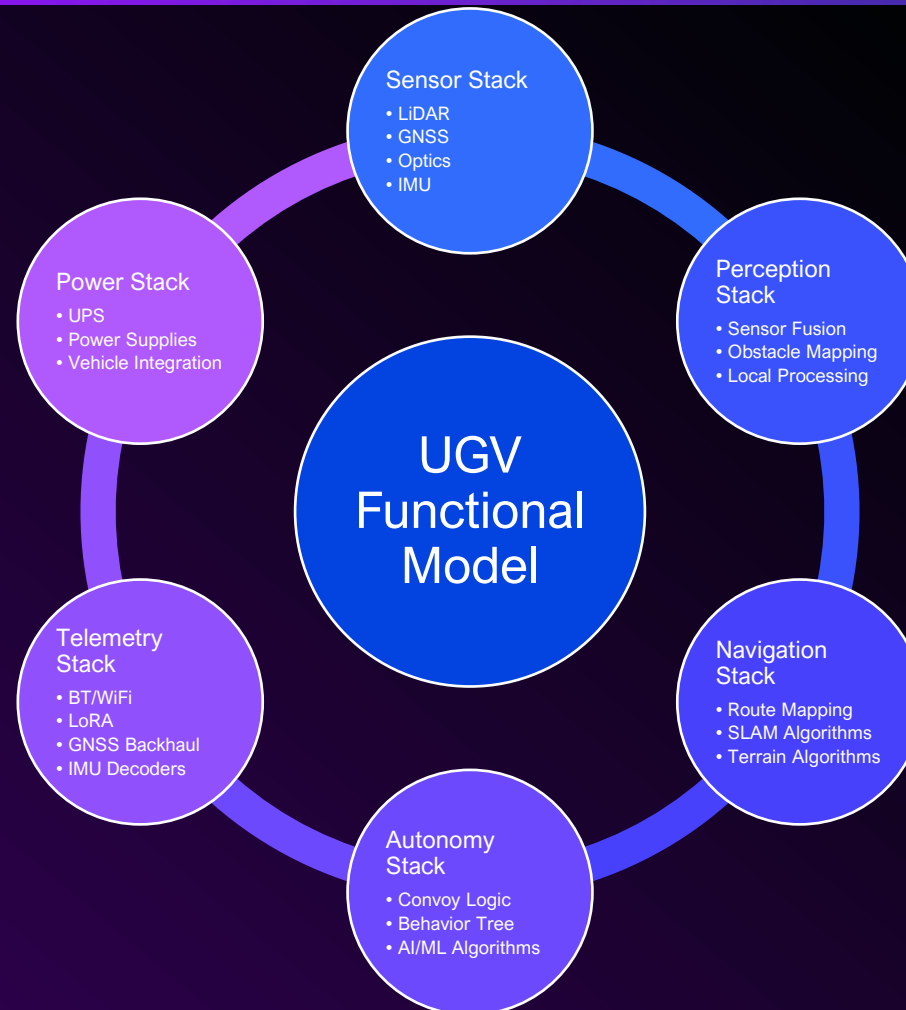


1. Retrofit mass < 250kg
2. Install time <5 hours
3. Runtime >12 hours
4. Size must not exceed tactical vehicle footprint
5. Fully self-contained functionality
6. No hydraulic, vacuum, or engine-tap dependencies

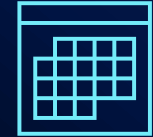


# STACK ARCHITECTURE

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# DEPLOYMENT SCHEDULE



## Design Validation

- Months 1-3

## HMMWV Integration

- Months 4-6

## Field Testing on Tactical Motor Pool

- Months 6-9

## Retrofit Kit Production

- Month 10

## Initial Deployment

- Month 12



# RETROFIT ARCHITECTURE SUMMARY

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- Non-invasive drive-by-wire control interface
- Steering controlled via non-invasive electric actuator integrated with existing steering system
- Bolt-on GNSS, LiDAR, stereo vision, and V2V radios
- Rugged onboard compute unit (MIL-SPEC compliant)
- Power drawn from host vehicle or auxiliary battery
- No structural modifications required



# PLATFORM COMPATIBILITY/IMPACT

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- Compatible with HMMWV, MRAP, JLTV, and DAGOR
- Preserves all original vehicle dimensions
- 250mm choke ring antenna is removable/stowable
- Fully compliant with convoy and transport logistics
- No impact on air, rail, or sea transportability



# VERIFICATION - VALIDATION



- Unit tests on perception, SLAM, and communications systems
- Software-in-the-loop (SIL) and hardware-in-the-loop (HIL) simulations
- Environmental test chambers for sensors  
- Range testing of V2V mesh network and GNSS fixed-solution resiliency in combination with dead reckoning IMU decoder

- Convoy testing in real-world terrain (Class I–III off-road routes, DoD Facility Combat Driver Training Courses)
- Operator feedback from simulated remote override trials
- Field scenarios: Obstacle avoidance, GNSS dropout, failed leader-detection
- Acceptance criteria: Spacing accuracy, obstacle miss-rates, uptime percentage





# STRATEGIC ADVANTAGES TO A RETROFIT SOLUTION

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- Preserves investment in existing DoD vehicles
- Supports scalability to multi-UGV convoys
- Rapid integration using existing vehicle interfaces
- Designed for GNSS-degraded environments with OTA support
- Cost-effective autonomy solution without platform redesign





# UGV SELECTION

## OVERVIEW

*"THE UGV SHOULD STRIVE TO LIMIT THE  
CONVOY'S SPEED, ENDURANCE, AND TERRAIN  
CAPABILITY AS LITTLE AS POSSIBLE AS  
COMPARED TO THE HMMWV"*



# LEAD VEHICLE ANALYSIS

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Figure 1

*Lead Vehicle: M998 A0 Series*



*Sourced from Military.com*

- Diesel
- 4 Wheeled
- 6.2 Liter V8
- 3 Speed Automatic
- Driveshaft/Propeller Shaft Rear Axle with 2 U-Joints
- Suspension: independent 4x4
- Weight: 5,220 to 5,920 lb curb weight, 7,020 to 8,520 gross weight
- Length: 15 ft (4.57 m), wheelbase 10 ft 10 in (3.30 m)
- Width: 7 ft 1 in (2.16 m)
- Height: 6 ft (1.83 m), reducible to 4 ft 6 in (1.37 m)





# UGV OPTION ANALYSIS

Figure 2  
*HMMWV - M998 A0 Series*



Sourced from Military.com

- L x W x H: 15' x 7' x 6'
- 70 mph top speed
- 350-mile range
- Diesel (multi-fuel)
- 2500 lbs. max payload

Figure 3  
*JLTV – Joint Light Tactical Vehicle*



Sourced from Military.com

- L x W x H: 20.5' x 8' x 8.5'
- 70 mph top speed
- 300-mile range
- Diesel (multi-fuel)
- 5100 lbs. max payload

Figure 4  
*HDT – Hunter WOLF*



Sourced from HDTglobal.com

- L x W x H: 5' x 4.5' x 4'
- 10 mph top speed
- 200-mile range
- Electric power
- 2200 lbs. max payload



# PROPOSED FOLLOWER UGV, POWER TRAIN, SIZE & WEIGHT

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Figure 4

*UGV follower: M998 A0 Series*



*Sourced from Getty Images*

- Uniform Size, Speed, and Range
- Diesel Engine, multi-fuel capable
- 4-wheel drive, off-road ready
- 3-speed automatic
- GVW 7700 lbs.
- L x W x H – 15' x 7' x 6'
- UGV Retrofit Component Weight – <500 lbs.



## SUMMARY

- Provision of a resilient, modular system architecture
- Designed to exceed stakeholder needs by providing a future-proof UGV operational model
- Positioned for expansion into multi-follower convoy configurations
- Bolt-on retrofit to existing tactical motor pool assets

## NEXT STEPS...

- Collaborate on defining scope and priorities
- Identify subsystem configuration preferences, finalize design, and begin controlled system-level simulations
- Prepare for the first integrated convoy field test in a suitable environment

QUESTIONS?



# THANK YOU

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Joel Garcia, Trey Hardin, Christopher Sperduto

Embry-Riddle Aeronautical University

UNSY-603: UAS Operational Configuration

May 25, 2025



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